

CHRISTIAN MESÍA-MONTENEGRO, Ph.D.

ACADEMIC EXECUTIVE CURRICULUM VITAE

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Stanford-trained scholar and university executive with institution-wide leadership experience in research strategy, academic affairs, faculty governance, research integrity, intellectual property, technology transfer, graduate education, and museum administration. Former Research Vice-Rector and Academic Vice-Rector at two universities; currently Director of Research, Innovation and Sustainability at Universidad Privada del Norte (UPN) and Professor. Active international researcher in archaeology, quantitative chronology, cultural heritage, and research methods.

EXECUTIVE SCOPE AND SELECTED OUTCOMES

Current research organization	58 research and innovation professionals; eight direct-report managers; approximately US\$2.1M annual research and innovation budget; multi-campus responsibility within a university of 127,000+ students and 4,500+ faculty and staff.
University-wide leadership	Academic Vice-Rector at universities of approximately 20,000 students/1,500 faculty and 15,000 students/1,000 faculty, with six and five deans reporting directly, respectively.
Research performance	UPN publications in Q1-Q2 journals: +18% from 2023 to 2024 and +22% from 2024 to 2025. As Research Vice-Rector at San Juan Bautista, scientific output increased 25% during tenure.
Change leadership	Curriculum redesign across five schools; institution-wide faculty recruitment and performance systems; seven accreditation processes; student-success measures associated with a 15-percentage-point reduction in attrition.
Innovation and integrity	UPN ranked #1 nationally in patents awarded for six consecutive years, 2020-2025 (Indecopi). Current portfolio includes technology transfer and the UPN Innovation HUB. Chair, Scientific Integrity Committee and Institutional Research Ethics Committee.

CURRENT APPOINTMENT

Director of Research, Innovation and Sustainability | Universidad Privada del Norte (UPN) | 2022-present

- Lead institution-wide research, innovation, intellectual property, technology transfer, competitive funding, research ethics, scientific integrity, research performance, and sustainability strategy across a large multi-campus university.
- Manage an annual research and innovation budget of approximately US\$2.1 million; directly supervise eight managers and lead 58 professionals; oversee planning, resource allocation, faculty research incentives, and university-wide support systems.
- Lead research support across engineering, health sciences, business, social sciences, humanities, and technology, using different funding and support models for different disciplinary needs.
- Led productivity and quality strategies associated with 18% growth in Q1-Q2 publications from 2023 to 2024 and a further 22% from 2024 to 2025.
- Chair the Scientific Integrity Committee and Institutional Research Ethics Committee; work with faculty councils, research committees, and academic leadership on policy, standards, and institutional risk.
- Current portfolio includes IP strategy and technology transfer. UPN ranked first among Peruvian universities in patents awarded for six consecutive years, 2020-2025, according to Indecopi; during current tenure, supported the launch of the UPN Innovation HUB and a September 2026 technology-transfer agreement with Coopagro for CoffeeX/VisionCoffeeX, a TRL 7 technology moving into productive-setting validation.
- Professor (Profesor Ordinario Principal), 2022-present.

SENIOR ACADEMIC AND ADMINISTRATIVE LEADERSHIP

Vice-Rector for Research | Universidad Privada San Juan Bautista | 2020-2022

- Led university-wide research policy, scientific production, research training, innovation, compliance, and institutional research systems, with two general directors reporting directly.
- Scientific output increased 25% during tenure.
- Professor (Profesor Ordinario Principal), 2020-2022.

Vice-Rector for Academic Affairs | Universidad Privada San Juan Bautista | 2019-2020

- Held university-wide academic responsibility for approximately 20,000 students and 1,500 faculty, with six deans reporting directly.
- Led academic strategy, faculty affairs, program quality, policy, curriculum, and cross-school coordination; standardized faculty recruitment, retention, performance evaluation, and development processes.
- Presided over faculty councils and academic committees and used shared-governance structures to develop and implement institutional policy.

Vice-Rector for Academic Affairs | Universidad Científica del Sur | 2018-2019

- Held university-wide academic responsibility for approximately 15,000 students and 1,000 faculty, with five deans reporting directly.
- Led academic strategy, faculty development, program quality, curriculum, and policy across scientific, professional, social-science, and humanities fields; led curriculum redesign across five schools.
- Standardized faculty recruitment, retention, and performance evaluation; chaired the Scientific Integrity Committee; led SINEACE accreditation across seven programs and student-success measures associated with a 15-percentage-point reduction in attrition.

Dean, Faculty of Human Sciences | Universidad Científica del Sur | 2017-2018

- Led academic planning, programs, faculty coordination, curriculum, and development of the human sciences; represented the Faculty in university governance.

Executive Director, Vice-Rectorate for Research | Universidad San Ignacio de Loyola | 2015-2017

- Managed institutional research initiatives, performance indicators, scientific production, competitive funding, research-office operations, project administration, policy, and coordination with academic units.

Academic Director, Graduate School | Universidad San Ignacio de Loyola | 2014-2015

- Led graduate academic coordination, program delivery, academic quality, faculty coordination, and Graduate School operations.

EDUCATION AND ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Ph.D., Anthropological Sciences | Stanford University | 2007

M.A., Anthropological Sciences | Stanford University | 2004

Licenciado en Arqueología | Universidad Nacional Mayor de San Marcos | 2000

B.A./Bachiller, Social Sciences | Universidad Nacional Mayor de San Marcos | 1998

Earlier academic appointments: Lecturer, Stanford University (2006); Lecturer, Universidad de Alcalá de Henares (2005); Profesor Ordinario Auxiliar, Universidad Nacional Mayor de San Marcos (2008-2010); teaching appointments at Stanford and San Marcos.

RESEARCH LEADERSHIP, PARTNERSHIPS AND FUNDING

- 2002-present | Chavín de Huántar Research Program | Co-Director with John W. Rick (Stanford University). Long-term international research program supported at different stages by Stanford University, National Geographic Society, Antamina, Global Heritage Fund, and others.
- 2017-present | Starch and Lipid Analysis from Chavín de Huántar Ceramic Vessels | Director; collaboration with Harvard University and Universidade de São Paulo.
- 2020-present | Macabalaca Research Project | Director; co-directed with Ángel Sánchez-Borjas (Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú).
- 2025 | Central Coast Geoglyphs Research Project | Director; co-directed with Ángel Sánchez-Borjas (Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú).
- Under current UPN leadership, institutional teams secured four directly documented competitive PROCENCIA-CONCYTEC awards totaling approximately US\$475,000, in addition to international and multi-institutional collaborations.
- Selected personal research support: National Geographic Society Research Fellowship and Field Research Grant; Newton Fund workshop grant; U.S. Embassy Ambassador's Fund; Stanford Archaeology Center; Stanford Center for Latin American Studies.

MUSEUM AND CULTURAL INSTITUTION LEADERSHIP

Director, Museo Nacional de la Cultura Peruana | 2013

Director, Museo de Arte Precolombino Casa del Alabado, Ecuador | 2011-2013

Director, Museo Nacional de Arqueología, Antropología e Historia del Perú | 2009-2010

Director, Museo Nacional Chavín | 2007-2009

Curator, Museo Nacional de Arqueología, Antropología e Historia del Perú | 1999-2022

SCHOLARSHIP AND ACADEMIC STANDING

- RENACYT-CONCYTEC Level III nationally certified researcher (Peru).
- Active scholarship in Andean archaeology, social complexity, Bayesian chronology, simulation-based methods, cultural heritage, and research systems.
- Peer reviewer for international journals including *Ñawpa Pacha*, *Open Life Sciences*, *Chungará*, *Journal of Field Archaeology*, and *Journal of Archaeological Science: Reports*.
- Current book projects: *Ritual Power and Built Authority in the Andean Formative* (Routledge) and *Historia mínima de Chavín* (Instituto de Estudios Peruanos).

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- Mesía-Montenegro, C. (2026). Identifying activity pulses in radiocarbon sequences: A Monte Carlo kernel-minima approach and simulation assessment. *Radiocarbon*, First View, 1-14.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C., & Sánchez-Borjas, Á. (2026). Geoglyphs and formative-period activity in the middle Chillón Valley, Peru: Ceramic association and null-model tests of route proximity. *PLOS ONE*, 21(6), e0350855.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C., & Sánchez-Borjas, A. (2026). Probabilistic forecasting reveals a silent collapse of archaeological heritage in Peru's Chillón Valley. *Journal of Cultural Heritage*, 78, 187-197.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C. (2025). Time, ritual, and Bayesian reasoning: Charting the Andean Kotosh religious tradition. *Archaeological and Anthropological Sciences*, 17(12), 244.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C., Cornejo-Guerrero, M., & Sánchez-Borjas, A. (2025). U-shaped power: Infantas and the ritual-political nexus of Formative-period monumentality in the Chillón Valley, Perú. *Antiquity*, 99(408), e57.
- Sánchez-Borjas, A., Mesía-Montenegro, C., & Narváez-Luna, J. (2024). Geoglyphs in the Andean Central Coast: Combining digital and traditional survey techniques. *Antiquity*, 98(402), e35.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C. (2024). Untangling the chronological complexities of the Andean Central Coast Formative Period: A Bayesian reassessment. *Journal of Archaeological Science: Reports*, 59, 104799.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C., & Weber, S. L. (2024). Starch analyses on culinary equipment from Chavín de Huántar. *Latin American Antiquity*, 35(3), 779-791.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C., & Sánchez-Borjas, A. (2023). Embedded religiousness and the Kotosh religious tradition in highland Peru: The site of La Seductora. *Antiquity*, 97(392), 367-385.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C., & Sánchez-Borjas, A. (2022). Macabalaca: New evidence of the Kotosh Religious Tradition in the Huarmey Valley, Peru. *Latin American Antiquity*, 33(4), 870-878.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C. (2022). Social complexity and core-periphery relationships in an Andean Formative ceremonial centre: Domestic occupation at Chavín de Huántar. *Antiquity*, 96(388), 883-902.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C. (2022). Evolutionary archaeology or evolutionary archaeologies? From progressionism to the pursuit of a Darwinian archaeology. *Terra Sebus*, 14, 41-66.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C. (2021). Innovación social y ciencia ciudadana en la gestión del patrimonio en un escenario post COVID-19. *Revista de Ciencias Sociales*, 27(2), 13-17.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C. (2018). A dangerous mistake: Research as a commodity in university institutions. *Anais da Academia Brasileira de Ciências*, 90(4), 3241-3242.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C. (2018). Julio Tello as a medical anthropologist: Assessing the antiquity of syphilis in ancient Peru. *História, Ciências, Saúde-Manguinhos*, 25(2), 541-552.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C. (2018). A short assessment of social inequality through evolutionary lenses: Re-examining Marx and Weber (and Darwin as well). *Human Affairs*, 28(2), 101-118.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C. (2017). Was Childe an Orientalist? An updated view of Gordon Childe's *The Dawn of European Civilization* and *New Light on the Most Ancient East*. *Terra Sebus*, 9, 9-20.
- Mesía-Montenegro, C. (2014). Festines y poder en Chavín de Huántar durante el período formativo tardío en los Andes Centrales. *Chungara Revista de Antropología Chilena*, 46(3), 313-343.

SELECTED BOOK CHAPTERS AND REVIEW

2023 | Mesía-Montenegro, C. "To Convince, Indoctrinate, and Rule: Religion and the Exercise of Power in Chavín de Huántar over an Intermediate Area in the Middle and Late Andean Formative." In Y. Seki (Ed.), *New Perspectives on the Early Formation of the Andean Civilization*. National Museum of Ethnology, Japan.

2017 | Mesía-Montenegro, C. "Estudios sobre el Periodo Formativo Andino en los Andes Centrales." In R. Vega-Centeno (Ed.), *Repensando el Antiguo Perú*. Instituto de Estudios Peruanos / Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú.

2013 | Mesía-Montenegro, C. "The Discovery of the Temple and Early Attempts at Interpretation." In P. Fux (Ed.), *Chavín: Peru's Enigmatic Temple in the Andes*. Museum Rietberg.

2013 | Mesía-Montenegro, C. "The Ecuadorian Formative Period." In P. Fux (Ed.), *Chavín: Peru's Enigmatic Temple in the Andes*. Museum Rietberg.

2001 | Gonzales Carré, E., & Mesía-Montenegro, C. "Wari, un Imperio por definir." In L. Millones Santagadea (Ed.), *Wari, Arte Precolombino*. Fundación El Monte.

2016 | Book review: Seki, Y. (Ed.), *El Centro Ceremonial Andino. Nuevas Perspectivas para los Periodos Arcaico y Formativo*. *Anthropos*, 111(1), 295-297.

SELECTED INTERNATIONAL PRESENTATIONS

2026 | European Association of Archaeologists Annual Meeting, Athens - Time, Ritual, and Bayesian Reasoning: Charting the Andean Kotosh Religious Tradition.

2026 | Society for American Archaeology Annual Meeting, San Francisco - Time, Ritual, and Bayesian Reasoning: Charting the Andean Kotosh Religious Tradition.

2025 | European Assembly of Archaeology of the Americas, Matera - Resolving Chronological Challenges of the Andean Central Coast Formative Period: A Bayesian Reanalysis.

2024 | Society for American Archaeology Annual Meeting, New Orleans - Chavín de Huántar and the chronology of the Andean Formative Period in Lima.

2022 | QS Higher Ed Summit: Americas, Brazil - Transforming the research management mindset: shared value, social innovation, and citizen science.

TEACHING, MENTORING AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- Undergraduate and graduate teaching at Stanford University, Universidad Nacional Mayor de San Marcos, Universidad San Ignacio de Loyola, Universidad Científica del Sur, Universidad Privada San Juan Bautista, and Universidad Privada del Norte; additional lecturer appointment at Universidad de Alcalá de Henares.
- Supervised approximately five undergraduate theses; served on at least five master's thesis committees and three doctoral dissertation committees.
- Designed or substantially revised the Doctor of Business Administration at Universidad San Ignacio de Loyola, Master's Program in Scientific Research at UPN, and Archaeology and Sustainable Tourism curricula at Universidad Científica del Sur.
- Consulting and specialized service: FONDECYT-PROCIENCIA; Greenpeace International; World Bank; Ministry of Culture of Peru.
- Professional affiliations: European Association of Archaeologists; Society for American Archaeology; Institute of Andean Studies; American Alliance of Museums; Stanford Alumni Association; ICOMOS.
- Languages: Spanish (native); English (advanced/professional); French (intermediate). Quantitative/research tools: R, Python, JMP, OxCal, QGIS.